

Tony Li

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EDUCATION

08/2024–Present	Stony Brook University Ph.D. in Computer Science; Advisor: Xiaojun Bi
08/2020–06/2024	University of Science and Technology of China (USTC) B.E. in Computer Science and Technology

EXPERIENCE

11/2026–05/2027	Incoming Student Researcher, Google , Mountain View, CA Expected to research personalized natural language generation for AI writing assistants, modeling users' writing styles and intended content.
06/2026–08/2026	GenAI Research Intern, Samsung Ads , Mountain View, CA - Developed cacheable, target-aware user representations for advertising recommendation under a 256-byte per-user cache budget. - Investigated multi-slot user modeling, LLM-based representation learning, and knowledge distillation for efficient personalization.
08/2024–Present	Graduate Research Assistant, Stony Brook University - Developed LLM-based keyboard decoders for personalized vocabulary adaptation (LEXGR) and ten-finger touchscreen typing (KeySense, CHI 2026). - Co-led a decoder analysis framework (DecoLego) and investigated gesture/tap input across mobile, AR, and VR interfaces.
07/2023–04/2024	Research Intern, Simon Fraser University ; Advisor: Xing-Dong Yang Developed a battery-free wireless textile sensing interface and computational tools for textile haptics (CHI 2025).

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Under Review	Li, Tony , CHEN, Z., ZHU, P., MA, Y., AND BI, X. LEXGR: Extending Flexible LLM-Based Keyboard Decoding to New Words
Under Review	CHEN, Z. *, Li, Tony *, ZHU, P., AND BI, X. DecoLego: A Functional Framework for Probing, Recomposing, and Extending Keyboard Decoders
Under Review	NEWTON, F., Li, Tony , BI, X., AND LEIVA, L. A. Decoding without Profiling: Privacy-Preserving Gesture Typing through Backtracking
Under Review	CHEN, Z., ZHU, P., CHEN, Y., Li, Tony , GU, X. D., MIAO, X., YU, L., AND BI, X. Structure Before Prose: A Persistent Argument Representation for Source-Grounded Legal Writing
CHI'26	Li, Tony , MA, Y., LI, Z., YU, C., RAMAKRISHNAN, I. V., AND BI, X. KeySense: LLM-Powered Hands-Down, Ten-Finger Typing on Commodity Touchscreens
CHI'25	XU, W., Li, Tony , WANG, Y., YANG, X.-D., AND WU, T.-Y. BIT: Battery-free, IC-less and Wireless Smart Textile Interface and Sensing System
VRW'25	MA, Y., Li, Tony , LI, Z., AND BI, X. LLM-powered Text Entry in Virtual Reality

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming	Python, C/C++, C#, Java, SQL, Bash
ML Frameworks	PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face Transformers
LLM / GenAI	Supervised fine-tuning (SFT), PEFT/LoRA, knowledge distillation, reinforcement learning (RL), RLHF, preference optimization (DPO)
User Modeling	Representation learning, personalization, recommendation/ranking systems, target-aware modeling, sequence modeling
Development	Unity, Android Studio, Flask, Django; AR/VR prototyping